

Ali Wallick

Game Developer · Software Engineer · Orange County, California

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with fifteen years building game clients, UI systems, and the tooling behind them. Seven of those at Second Dinner, through Marvel Snap's launch, its PC release, and now a new project in Godot.

SKILLS

Engines & Tools Unity · Godot · Git · Cursor · Claude Code

Languages C# · GDScript · Lua

Platforms iOS · Android · PC

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer I · Second Dinner 2019 – Present
Irvine, CA

Joined as the eleventh employee, interviewing and helping shape the culture as the studio grew past 100.

Unreleased Mobile Game 2024 – Present

Moved to a new team in 2024 to build the studio's first game in Godot.

- **UI Framework:** Built the game's UI framework. Other engineers develop reusable interface code against it.
- **Client Engineering:** Built client testing workflows and Godot editor tooling for the team. Reported and fixed engine bugs with partners at W4 Games. Delivered engine version updates and native mobile plugin integration.
- **Agentic Workflows:** Contributed to the team's agentic commands and skills, and built automation into CI.

Marvel Snap 2019 – 2024

Client then feature engineer, from prototype through production, the mobile and PC releases, and live operations.

- **Architecture:** Built tooling that made an MVVM architecture practical to adopt on a live product, alongside the PC client launch. Helped teammates migrate their working patterns onto it.
- **PC Launch:** Shipped the PC client, reworking much of the mobile UI for landscape and mouse-and-keyboard play.
- **Feature Engineering:** Built meta gameplay systems spanning client and server code, the interfaces for them, card and deck cosmetics, and the deckbuilding UI.
- **Card Credits:** Proposed and shipped in-game artist attribution for card art, requested by players since launch. Covered by gaming press, GamesRadar among them, at its January 2023 release.
- **Tooling:** Built Unity Editor and in-game tooling, including the artists' card art tool and the developer console.
- **Localization:** Owned the feature end to end in 15 languages, including Unity's Localization package, the import and export pipeline, font handling, and the team's UI text workflow. Extended font support with CJK fallback to OS typefaces and correct rendering for Thai's stacked diacritics. Kept only shipped glyphs resident, loading player-typed text dynamically.
- **Live-Ops Content:** Built the Braze integration that allowed live-ops and marketing to publish the main-screen carousel, news page, and modal pop-ups without an app update.
- **Client Engineering:** Delivered push notifications and deep linking in the Unity client.
- **Awards:** Marvel Snap won Best Mobile Game at The Game Awards in 2022, and Mobile Game of the Year at the DICE Awards in 2023.

- **Vegas Blvd Slots:** Architected the live-ops systems, including a server-controllable store and a DeltaDNA integration driving in-app messaging and promo carousels. Customizable text let marketing run its own campaigns.
- **Slot Machines:** Engineered new machines, their features, and their bonus games, on a title carrying more than 50 machines. Its meta systems included rewards, gifting, leagues, and tournaments.
- **I Fits I Sits:** Pitched the concept at the studio game jam and built the week-long prototype. Focused on a level editor the team used to author 61 levels. It won People's Choice, and other teams later released it as Puzzle Cats. The editor exported JSON, and the intro levels the designers built taught the mechanics with no separate tutorial. It shipped first on Facebook Instant Games as It Fits I Sits.
- **Compliance & Upgrades:** Led GDPR support and several major Unity version upgrades across the title.
- **Hot Streak Slots:** Ported the studio's previous slots title from native iOS to Unity.
- **Unreleased Casino:** Built blackjack, video poker, and keno for an early casino app. Its team later merged into Vegas Blvd Slots, which shipped as slots only.

- **Firefall:** Built UI across the HUD and menus through the game's Chinese launch and worldwide relaunch overhaul. Delivered the radar, the PvP HUD, character progression and elite-level screens, and reward screens.
- **UI Systems:** Created shared libraries for common menu and HUD elements, and optimized the UI system itself on an already-loaded client.
- **Engine Integration:** Worked at the boundary between the Lua and XML UI scripting layer and the studio's C++ engine. Contributed to the engine codebase as well as the UI layer.

- **UI Programming:** Built many of Kaneva's core menus end to end in the in-house Lua menu system. Architected the menu animation system that replaced hand-coded transitions, which both the UI and game teams adopted. Took the player and creator HUDs, inventory and bank, travel, events, context menus, and the welcome tutorial from artists' comps through to release. Worked with the engine and web teams whenever a menu touched either.
- **Creator Tools:** Built a visual property editor for scripted objects, menus for swapping video and Flash content onto them, and the builder walkthrough.
- **Game Programming:** Helped design and script a Lua-based game development environment built on top of the virtual world.
- **Technical Support:** Joined Kaneva in support, helping players with their in-world scripting. Built game templates, Treasure Hunt and Adventure among them, which players used to assemble small games of their own.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

- **Critter³:** Programmed a cube-world puzzle game at Global Game Jam 2011. Reached the finals of SCAD's Entelechy prototype contest that May.
- **Cor Ex Machina:** Programmed and designed a herding game at Global Game Jam 2013. Placed second at Atlanta, the largest jam site in the country that year.
- **Speaking:** Spoke on panels at the Museum of Design Atlanta and SIEGE in 2013. Gave talks for a Girl Scout troop in 2020 and a college class on the work itself in 2023.

EDUCATION
